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**CYBER SKYLINE**

The National Cyber League  
A Community Where Cybersecurity Is a Passion

Nathan Kuechler

# NCL Spring 2026 Individual Game Scouting Report

Dear Nathan Kuechler,

Thank you for participating in the National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 Season! Our goal is to prepare the next generation of cybersecurity professionals, and your participation is helping achieve that goal.

The NCL was founded in May 2011 to provide an ongoing virtual training ground for collegiate students to develop, practice, and validate their cybersecurity skills in preparation for further learning, industry certifications, and career readiness. The NCL scenario-based challenges were designed around performance-based exam objectives of CompTIA certifications and are aligned to the National Initiative for Cybersecurity Education (NICE) Cybersecurity Workforce Framework published by the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST).

As you look to a future career in cybersecurity, we hope you find this report to be valuable in both validating skills and identifying areas for improvement across the nine NCL skills categories. You can use this NCL Scouting Report to:

- Validate your skills to employers in any job application or professional portfolio;
- Show case your achievements and strengths by including the Score Card view of your performance as part of your résumé or simply sharing the validation link so that others may view the detailed version of this report.

The NCL Spring 2026 Season had 7,520 students/players and 583 faculty/coaches from more than 440 two- and four-year schools & 220 high schools across all 50 U.S. states registered to play. The Individual Game Capture the Flag (CTF) event took place from April 10 through April 12. The Team Game CTF event took place from April 24 through April 26. The games were conducted in real-time for students across the country. You were in the Experienced Students Bracket, consisting of students enrolled in advanced degrees or hold extensive industry working experience.

NCL is powered by Cyber Skyline's cloud-based skills evaluation platform. Cyber Skyline hosted the scenario-driven cybersecurity challenges for players to compete and track their progress in real-time.



To validate this report, please access: [cyberskyline.com/report/7WWFB33HM7VG](https://cyberskyline.com/report/7WWFB33HM7VG)



Based on the performance detailed in this NCL Scouting Report, you have earned **11 hours** of Continuing Education Units (CEUs) as approved by CompTIA. You can learn more about the NCL - CompTIA alignment via [nationalcyberleague.org/partners](https://nationalcyberleague.org/partners).

Congratulations for your participation in the NCL Spring 2026 Individual Game! We hope you will continue to develop your knowledge and skills and make meaningful contributions as part of the Information Security workforce!

Dr. David Zeichick  
NCL Commissioner



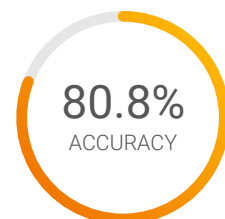
POWERED BY  
**CYBER SKYLINE**

**EXPERIENCED  
STUDENTS RANK  
111<sup>TH</sup> PLACE  
OUT OF 466  
PERCENTILE  
77<sup>TH</sup>**

## NATIONAL CYBER LEAGUE SCORE CARD

NCL SPRING 2026 INDIVIDUAL GAME

### YOUR TOP CATEGORIES



Average: 72.5%

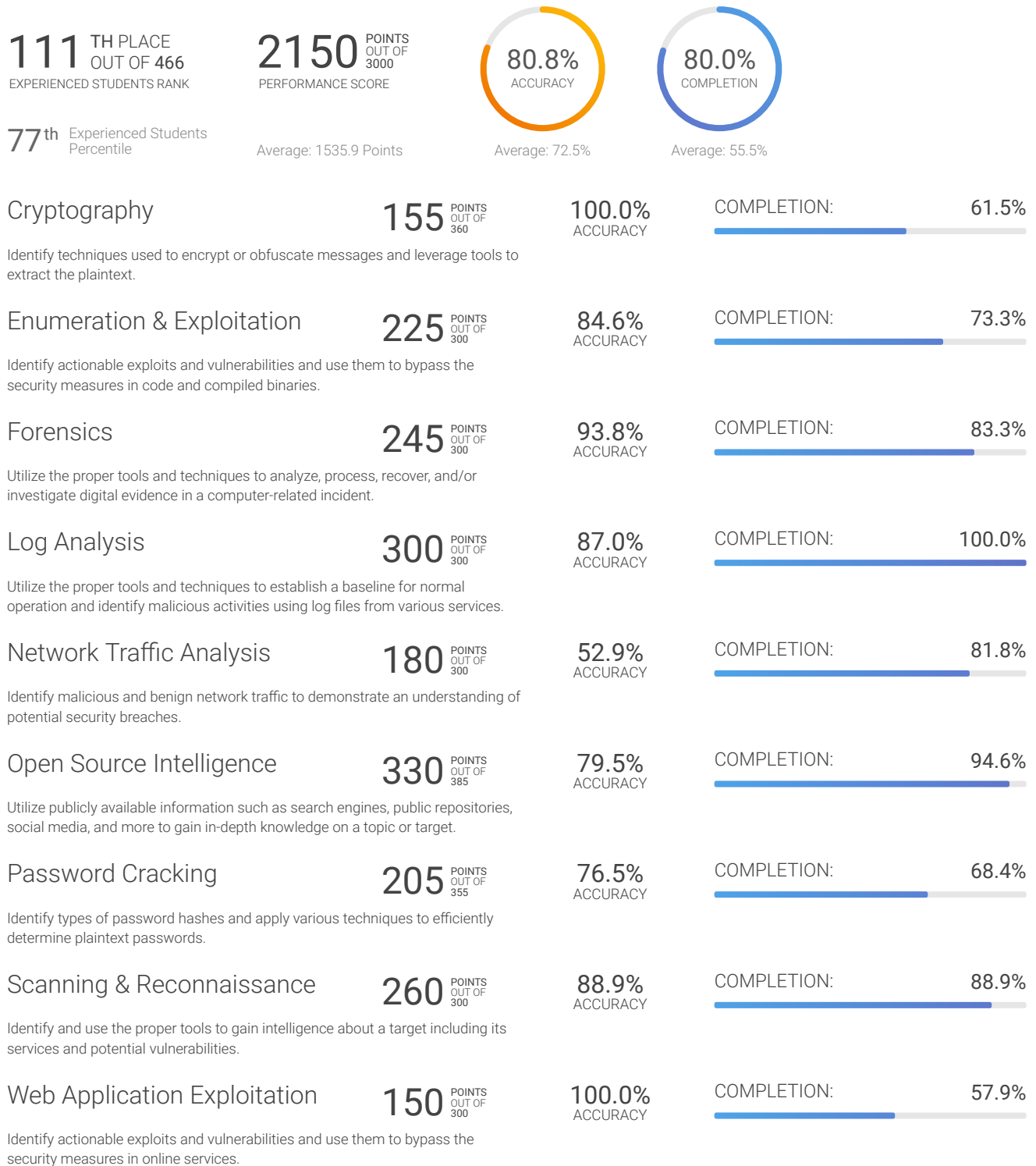
[cyberskyline.com/report/7WWFB33HM7VG](https://cyberskyline.com/report/7WWFB33HM7VG)

Learn more at [nationalcyberleague.org](https://nationalcyberleague.org)



## NCL Spring 2026 Individual Game

The NCL Individual Game is designed for student players nationwide to compete in realtime in the categories listed below. The Individual Game evaluates the technical cybersecurity skills of the individual, without the assistance of others.



Note: Survey module (100 points) was excluded from this report.



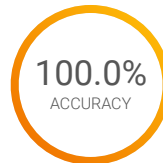


## Cryptography Module

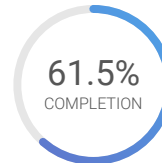
Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.

**159** TH PLACE  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**155** POINTS  
OUT OF 360  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 74.5%



Average: 61.2%

**66**<sup>th</sup> Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 194.5 Points

### DW (Easy)

**50** POINTS  
OUT OF 50

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Analyze and obtain the plaintext from text encoded with common number bases.

### dorsCrypt (Easy)

**50** POINTS  
OUT OF 50

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Manually decode a custom pigpen substitution cipher.

### Million Dollar Cat (Medium)

**40** POINTS  
OUT OF 55

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **80.0%**

Decode baudot telegram messages.

### Mirror (Medium)

**0** POINTS  
OUT OF 40

**0.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

Brute force a single byte XOR key to decode a message.

### Lottery (Medium)

**15** POINTS  
OUT OF 90

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **30.0%**

Recover the internal seed from an insecurely used pseudo random number generator (PRNG).

### Broken Signer (Hard)

**0** POINTS  
OUT OF 75

**0.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

Compute an RSA private key from an unreliable signing oracle and decrypt the flag.



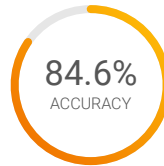


## Enumeration & Exploitation Module

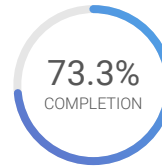
Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.

**113<sup>TH</sup>** PLACE  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**225** POINTS  
OUT OF 300  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 54.9%



Average: 55.2%

**76<sup>th</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 162.2 Points

### Chrooted (Easy)

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Research Linux system vulnerabilities and utilize an exploit against a vulnerable version of sudo.

### Breads (Medium)

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**83.3%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Reverse-engineer a C++ executable and find a hidden flag.

### Liber8eze (Hard)

**25** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**66.7%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **33.3%**

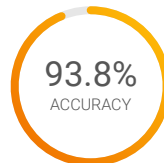
Exploit a running rust binary with a failure point being environment variable injection.

## Forensics Module

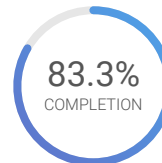
Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.

**83<sup>RD</sup>** PLACE  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**245** POINTS  
OUT OF 300  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 58.8%



Average: 47.8%

**83<sup>rd</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 145.9 Points

### Fly High (Easy)

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Extract hidden images concatenated from binaries and carve hidden information from images.

### Remote Recovery (Medium)

**75** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **80.0%**

Use open source tools to recover Windows Remote Desktop bitmap images.

### Heap Hunter (Hard)

**70** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**85.7%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **75.0%**

Analyze a process dump and recover IoCs related to a potential data exfiltration attack.



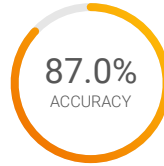


## Log Analysis Module

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.

**39<sup>TH</sup> PLACE**  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**300** POINTS  
OUT OF 300  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 60.0%



Average: 63.1%

**92<sup>ND</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 194.7 Points

### MCC (Easy)

Parse through simple csv logs using linux cmd line tools.

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**71.4%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

### Cloudy, with a Trail of Logs (Medium)

Analyze CloudTrail EC2 logs to identify user behaviors and potential IoCs.

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

### ADpocalypse (Hard)

Parse through .evtx logs to determine IoCs of a DCSync attack.

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**88.9%**  
ACCURACY

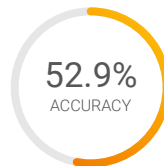
COMPLETION: **100.0%**

## Network Traffic Analysis Module

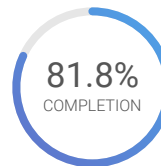
Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.

**146<sup>TH</sup> PLACE**  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**180** POINTS  
OUT OF 300  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 54.3%



Average: 57.3%

**69<sup>TH</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 158.2 Points

### Parsing DNS (Easy)

Parse packets containing network information and extract relevant fields for investigation.

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**60.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

### Compressed Analysis (Medium)

Identify Man-in-the-Middle (MITM) techniques and conduct an effective post compromise analysis of network traffic.

**70** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**58.3%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **77.8%**

### Replay (Hard)

Analyze a PCAP with ISO8583 messages and detect a replay attack.

**10** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**28.6%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **50.0%**





## Open Source Intelligence Module

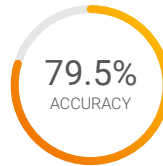
Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.

**116<sup>TH</sup>** PLACE  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

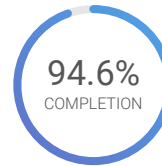
**330** POINTS  
OUT OF 385  
PERFORMANCE SCORE

**76<sup>th</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 255.1 Points



Average: 68.8%



Average: 73.7%

### Rules of Conduct (Easy)

**30** POINTS  
OUT OF 30

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Introductory challenge on acceptable conduct during NCL.

### BSides (Easy)

**55** POINTS  
OUT OF 55

**77.8%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Use open source tools to gather information about cybersecurity conferences.

### Badge (Easy)

**60** POINTS  
OUT OF 60

**66.7%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Perform a reverse image search to identify information about an RFID card reader.

### Shipping (Medium)

**40** POINTS  
OUT OF 50

**50.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **83.3%**

Use open source tools to collect information about foreign and domestic markets.

### Futbol (Medium)

**90** POINTS  
OUT OF 90

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Analyse historic data leaks to identify patterns and information for decisions.

### Ergo Propter Hoc (Hard)

**55** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **85.7%**

Trace back malicious actor movements through repositories, usernames, emails, and BTC addresses.



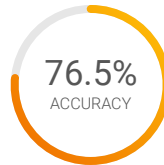


## Password Cracking Module

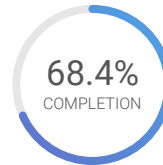
Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.

**98<sup>TH</sup> PLACE**  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**205** POINTS  
OUT OF 355  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 76.2%



Average: 49.6%

**79<sup>th</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 145.2 Points

### Hashed (Easy)

**30** POINTS  
OUT OF 30

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Generate hashes for passwords with the MD5, SHA1 and SHA256 hashing algorithms.

### Best64 (Easy)

**45** POINTS  
OUT OF 45

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Crack MD5 password hashes using Hashcat's best64 rules.

### Upload (Medium)

**0** POINTS  
OUT OF 45

**0.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

Crack a zip archive and an encrypted text file.

### Oph! (Medium)

**45** POINTS  
OUT OF 45

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Crack Windows NTLM password hashes using rainbow tables

### Unlocking (Medium)

**75** POINTS  
OUT OF 90

**50.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **75.0%**

Crack Bitlocker user password to open an encrypted Windows drive

### Serpens (Hard)

**10** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**50.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **33.3%**

Write a custom tool to crack SQLcipher database passwords.



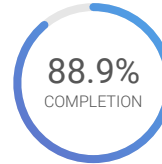
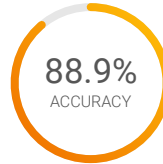


## Scanning & Reconnaissance Module

Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.

**126<sup>TH</sup>** PLACE  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**260** POINTS  
OUT OF 300  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



**73<sup>rd</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 181.7 Points

Average: 62.1%

Average: 60.3%

### Dig it up (Easy)

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Utilize DNS services to gain information about an organization's Intranet resources.

### Scandiego (Medium)

**85** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**85.7%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **85.7%**

Use reconnaissance techniques to identify information about avahi services on a remote machine.

### Verified (Hard)

**75** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**83.3%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **83.3%**

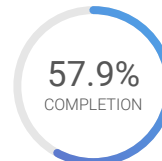
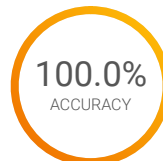
Scan a mail server, enumerate usernames and gain access to an IMAP service.

## Web Application Exploitation Module

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.

**129<sup>TH</sup>** PLACE  
OUT OF 466  
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

**150** POINTS  
OUT OF 300  
PERFORMANCE SCORE



**73<sup>rd</sup>** Experienced Students  
Percentile

Average: 146.3 Points

Average: 55.8%

Average: 50.3%

### Typing Racers (Easy)

**100** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Identify IDOR vulnerabilities to prevent unauthorized access to sensitive data.

### Liber8tion File Store (Medium)

**20** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **28.6%**

Bypass faulty proxy configurations and exploit a SQL injection to gain access to internal resources.

### JS Vault (Hard)

**30** POINTS  
OUT OF 100

**100.0%**  
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **50.0%**

Deobfuscate javascript to break insecure client-side secret storage.

